

Critics' Choice

WHAT CONNECTS THE

Hindi version of Oscar winning film *RRR* directed by S.S. Rajamouli, Oscar-winning documentary *The Elephant Whisperers* and the International Emmy-winning *Vir Das: Landing?* All of them are on Netflix India. Credit for this must go to Monika Shergill, who is leading the streaming giant's content strategy in India.

Shergill has manoeuvred Netflix India through a revised strategy that has seen it pump in a lot more money into local content. As a result, Netflix India's user engagement grew 30 per cent and revenue grew 24 per cent over a year at the end of December 2022, making it the company's fastest-growing market globally. "Our core strategy remains unchanged. We want to make Netflix



MONIKA SHERGILL
48, VICE PRESIDENT, CONTENT, NETFLIX INDIA

WHAT KEEPS ME GOING
The power of storytelling and the joy of collaborating with incredible creators

A LIFE LESSON LEARNT ON THE JOB
To listen and learn as much as possible through every experience

the service of choice for Indian audiences by offering an exciting line-up of quality series, films, documentaries and reality—and that's exactly what we are continuing to do," says Shergill.

As the overall streaming business in India completed seven years and the conversation turned towards profitability, Shergill says their focus is on building a healthy streaming business that is predicated on increasing engagement, revenue and profitability. After hit series and films such as *Scoop*, *Rana Naidu*, *Kohrra* and *Chor Nikal Ke Bhaga* in 2023, Netflix is now banking on *The Archies*, an original musical film packed with a cast of star kids and directed by Zoya Akhtar. "It is our mission to entertain our audiences and our film *The Archies* will take this to the next level," signs off Shergill. **BT**

— BY VIDYA S.

70 |



NADIA CHAUHAN
37, JOINT MD & CMO, PARLE AGRO

COOL CUSTOMER

Parle Agro's Nadia Chauhan doesn't like to stay contented. Self-driven like her father Prakash Chauhan, Nadia too aspires to catapult Parle Agro into a holistic beverages firm—that had a turnover of ₹8,500 crore in FY23. She has now set her eyes on a bigger target. "Our long-term objective is to... expand our portfolio... and

set a base of ₹30,000 crore (yearly revenue)." To that end, Chauhan is looking to double Parle's distribution to reach 4 million outlets. While she has managed to taste early success with the value-added dairy brand SMOODH with its affordable ₹10 packs, the formula is now being extended to Frooti with a new ₹5 pack, which she believes, could be a game changer. **BT**

— BY ARNAB DUTTA